

C494

Advanced Standing for RN License

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A nurse on a 32-bed medical-surgical unit that recently switched to 12-hour shifts receives report on four clients. Which client should the nurse see first?

- A. A client rating abdominal pain 6 of 10 who is due for pain medication.
- B. A client 6 hours after a thyroidectomy with new high-pitched, noisy breathing.
- C. A client with diabetes whose blood glucose before lunch is 180 mg/dL.
- D. A client anxious about discharge whose family is waiting in the room.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A client recovering from surgery in a busy teaching hospital is worried about telling his employer about his new diabetes diagnosis. He has not urinated in 9 hours, and his bladder is distended. His favorite team is in the playoffs. Which need should the nurse address first?

- A. Assess and manage the urinary retention.
- B. Talk through his worries about his employer.
- C. Start detailed diabetes teaching.
- D. Always address emotional needs first to build trust.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A charge nurse on an orthopedic floor with two new graduate nurses has one unlicensed assistive personnel (UAP) available. Which task is appropriate to delegate to the UAP?

- A. Give scheduled oral pain medication because it is routine.
- B. Assess a client's new calf pain and swelling.
- C. Measure and record vital signs for a stable client on the second day after surgery.
- D. Teach crutch walking to a client being discharged today.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which task must the RN keep rather than assign to a licensed practical nurse (LPN)?

- A.** Reinforcing teaching the RN already provided.
- B.** The initial admission assessment and care plan for a new client.
- C.** Giving scheduled oral medications to a stable client.
- D.** All medication tasks, since LPNs may never give medications.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

On a telemetry unit that just earned Magnet recognition, the nurse reviews four clients. Which finding needs attention first?

- A.** A client one day after surgery with a small amount of pink drainage on the dressing.
- B.** A client with chronic kidney disease whose creatinine is high but unchanged.
- C.** A client one day after hip surgery with sudden shortness of breath and chest pain.
- D.** A client with COPD whose oxygen saturation is 90%, the same as baseline.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A nurse in a pediatric clinic that sees 80 children a day is about to give an antibiotic. The child's mother, at the bedside, says, "Yes, that's my son." The room number matches the medication record. What should the nurse do before giving the dose?

- A.** Check two identifiers, such as name and date of birth, against the ID band and medication record.
- B.** Give it, since the mother confirmed who he is.
- C.** Skip identification because it is an outpatient clinic.
- D.** Use the room number as one of the two identifiers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A client in a hospital with private rooms has diarrhea and a positive test for *Clostridioides difficile*. The client enjoys crossword puzzles. Which precautions and hand hygiene apply?

- A.** Droplet precautions with a surgical mask.
- B.** Airborne precautions with an N95 and negative-pressure room.
- C.** Contact precautions with alcohol-based hand rub.
- D.** Contact precautions with gown and gloves, and soap-and-water hand washing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse must wear a fitted N95 respirator and place the client in a negative-pressure room. Which condition is most likely suspected?

- A.** Influenza.
- B.** Pulmonary tuberculosis.
- C.** Severe neutropenia.
- D.** Clostridioides difficile.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A client waiting for biopsy results in a quiet oncology clinic with a garden view says, “I just know it’s cancer.” The client’s spouse is parking the car. What is the most therapeutic response?

- A.** “Let’s wait until your spouse gets here to talk about it.”
- B.** “Why do you think that?”
- C.** “Don’t worry, I’m sure it’s nothing.”
- D.** “You sound worried. Tell me more about what you’re feeling.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which nurse response blocks therapeutic communication?

- A.** Sitting quietly with the client.
- B.** “Go on.”
- C.** “You seem upset.”
- D.** “If I were you, I would have the surgery.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A provider orders amoxicillin 500 mg by mouth. The pharmacy supplies an oral suspension of 250 mg per 5 mL. The client weighs 70 kg and prefers the medicine chilled. How many mL should the nurse give?

- A.** 10 mL
- B.** 70 mL
- C.** 2.5 mL
- D.** 5 mL

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse gives 7.5 mL of a solution that contains 40 mg per 5 mL. What dose did the client receive?

- A.** 26.7 mg
- B.** 40 mg
- C.** 60 mg
- D.** 300 mg

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	—	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A nurse on a 32-bed medical-surgical unit ~~that recently switched to 12-hour shifts~~ receives report on four clients. Which client should the nurse see first?

Target word: first client to see **Decides:** A new airway sign after neck surgery.

A	Adjacent category	Pain matters, but it comes after airway threats.
B	Correct	Stridor after neck surgery threatens the airway, the top ABC priority.
C	Confusion set	Abnormal but not immediately life-threatening.
D	Absolute language	Picking the most talkative case assumes emotional needs always come first; they rank below physiological threats.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A client recovering from surgery ~~in a busy teaching hospital~~ is worried about telling his employer about his new diabetes diagnosis. He has not urinated in 9 hours, and his bladder is distended. ~~His favorite team is in the playoffs.~~ Which need should the nurse address first?

Target word: first need **Decides:** Urinary retention is an unmet physiological need.

A	Correct	Physiological needs come first in Maslow's hierarchy.
B	Adjacent category	A psychosocial need that follows physiological needs.
C	Confusion set	Teaching is important but not before a physical problem is managed.
D	Absolute language	Physical needs take priority over emotional ones.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A charge nurse on an orthopedic floor ~~with two new graduate nurses~~ has one unlicensed assistive personnel (UAP) available. Which task is appropriate to delegate to the UAP?

Target word: task within UAP scope **Decides:** Routine data collection on a stable client.

A	Dropped element	Drops the scope rule; medication administration is outside UAP scope in most settings.
B	Adjacent category	A new finding needs RN assessment; it may signal a clot.
C	Correct	Routine measurement on a stable client fits UAP scope; the RN interprets the results.
D	Confusion set	Teaching stays with the licensed nurse.

4. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

Which task must the RN keep rather than assign to a licensed practical nurse (LPN)?

Target word: reverse: find the non-delegable task **Decides:** Initial assessment and care planning are RN-only.

A	Confusion set	LPNs may reinforce existing teaching.
B	Correct	Initial assessment and planning are RN responsibilities.
C	Adjacent category	Within LPN scope in most states.
D	Absolute language	LPNs routinely give many medications.

5. Answer C Concept 4

On a telemetry unit ~~that just earned Magnet recognition~~, the nurse reviews four clients. Which finding needs attention first?

Target word: most urgent finding **Decides:** A sudden, unexpected change.

A	Dropped element	Drops that small serosanguineous drainage is expected early after surgery.
B	Adjacent category	A chronic, stable finding.
C	Correct	An acute, unexpected change that may be a pulmonary embolism.
D	Confusion set	Abnormal but expected and stable for this client.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A nurse in a pediatric clinic ~~that sees 80 children a day~~ is about to give an antibiotic. The child's mother, at the bedside, says, "Yes, that's my son." The room number matches the medication record. What should the nurse do before giving the dose?

Target word: safe identification step **Decides:** Two approved identifiers are required.

A	Correct	Two identifiers are the standard; neither a parent's word nor a room counts alone.
B	Dropped element	Drops the two-identifier check.
C	Absolute language	Identification applies in every setting.
D	Confusion set	Room numbers are never acceptable identifiers.

7. Answer D Concept 6

A client in a hospital with private rooms has diarrhea and a positive test for *Clostridioides difficile*. ~~The client enjoys crossword puzzles.~~ Which precautions and hand hygiene apply?

Target word: precautions and hand hygiene **Decides:** *C. difficile* spores are not killed by alcohol.

A	Confusion set	Droplet precautions are for diseases like influenza.
B	Adjacent category	Airborne precautions are for TB, measles, and chickenpox.
C	Dropped element	Drops the spore problem; alcohol rub is not enough.
D	Correct	Contact spread; washing removes spores that alcohol does not kill.

8. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A nurse must wear a fitted N95 respirator and place the client in a negative-pressure room. Which condition is most likely suspected?

Target word: reverse: precautions given, name the disease **Decides:** Airborne precautions.

A	Confusion set	Influenza needs droplet precautions.
B	Correct	TB spreads by airborne particles.
C	Inverted operation	Protective isolation uses positive pressure to keep germs out, the reverse.
D	Adjacent category	Needs contact precautions.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A client waiting for biopsy results in a quiet oncology clinic ~~with a garden view~~ says, "I just know it's cancer." ~~The client's spouse is parking the car.~~ What is the most therapeutic response?

Target word: therapeutic response **Decides:** The client is voicing fear.

A	Camouflage	Answers the spouse detail and delays the client's need now.
B	Confusion set	"Why" questions can feel like demands to justify feelings.
C	Absolute language	False reassurance dismisses the client's concern.
D	Correct	Reflects the feeling and invites the client to share.

10. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

Which nurse response blocks therapeutic communication?

Target word: reverse: find the block **Decides:** Giving personal advice.

A	Inverted operation	Silence gives the client space; it is therapeutic.
B	Confusion set	A general lead that encourages talking.
C	Adjacent category	Making an observation is therapeutic.
D	Correct	Giving advice takes the decision away from the client.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A provider orders amoxicillin 500 mg by mouth. The pharmacy supplies an oral suspension of 250 mg per 5 mL. ~~The client weighs 70 kg and prefers the medicine chilled.~~ How many mL should the nurse give?

Target word: volume to give **Decides:** $500 \div 250 \times 5$ mL.

A	Correct	$(500 \div 250) \times 5$ mL = 10 mL.
B	Wrong stem number	The client's weight; this dose is not weight-based.
C	Inverted operation	Uses $250 \div 500$ instead of $500 \div 250$.
D	Dropped element	Gives one supply unit, which holds only 250 mg.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A nurse gives 7.5 mL of a solution that contains 40 mg per 5 mL. What dose did the client receive?

Target word: solve for dose given volume **Decides:** $40 \text{ mg} \div 5 \text{ mL} = 8 \text{ mg per mL}$.

A	Inverted operation	Uses $5 \div 7.5$ instead of $7.5 \div 5$.
B	Wrong stem number	The amount in 5 mL, not 7.5 mL.
C	Correct	$7.5 \text{ mL} \times 8 \text{ mg/mL} = 60 \text{ mg}$.
D	Dropped element	7.5×40 drops the "per 5 mL" part of the concentration.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	1	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	ABC prioritization	Airway, then breathing, then circulation come before other needs when choosing whom to see first.	Seeing the loudest complaint or the highest pain score first.	Noisy, high-pitched, or labored breathing in one of several clients.
2	Maslow's hierarchy	Physiological needs come before safety, then love and belonging, esteem, and self-actualization.	Addressing emotional worries before an unmet physical need.	A physical problem mixed with anxiety or teaching needs.
3	Delegation	The RN keeps assessment, teaching, evaluation, and care planning; stable, routine tasks may go to UAP within their scope.	Delegating teaching or new assessments because they seem simple.	"Which task can the RN assign to the UAP/LPN?"
4	Expected vs. unexpected findings	An acute, unexpected change is more urgent than an abnormal finding that is expected for the client's condition.	Treating any abnormal number as the top priority.	A chronic baseline next to a sudden new symptom.
5	Client identification for medications	Use two identifiers, such as name and date of birth, checked against the MAR and ID band; room number never counts.	Relying on a family member's word or the room number.	Someone vouches for the client, or a room number matches.
6	Transmission-based precautions	C. difficile: contact precautions and soap-and-water hand hygiene; TB: airborne, fitted N95 and negative pressure; influenza: droplet.	Using alcohol rub for C. difficile or a surgical mask for TB.	Spore-forming diarrhea vs. airborne vs. droplet disease.
7	Therapeutic communication	Use open-ended, feeling-focused responses; avoid false reassurance, "why" questions, and advice.	Offering reassurance that "everything will be fine."	A client voices fear or worry.
8	Dosage calculation	Volume = (desired dose ÷ dose on hand) × volume on hand.	Inverting the ratio or giving one unit volume.	An order in mg and a supply in mg per mL.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Standing for RN License